

# Action-Conditioned Predictive Consistency as a Diagnostic for Gaussian-Noise Robustness in JEPA World Models

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## Abstract

Latent predictive world models avoid pixel reconstruction, but pixel-free prediction is not a robustness definition for closed-loop control. We study this gap with action-conditioned predictive consistency (ACPC), a no-retraining diagnostic for JEPA-style control checkpoints. The diagnostic combines ACPC Tail Risk (ATR), which measures high-quantile clean/noisy rollout disagreement for the same state under the same action sequence, with Selective Margin Pass Rate (SMPR), which checks that task-grounded near-boundary distinctions remain separated. Across three independent LeWM training seeds and four control tasks, no-noise checkpoints are fragile under observation-only Gaussian noise, while input-side noise training yields broad matched-Gaussian robustness plateaus. At recovered endpoints, ATR is substantially lower and SMPR is near one across tasks. These results support ATR and SMPR as bounded ACPC diagnostics for matched-Gaussian robustness plateaus in fixed JEPA world-model checkpoints.

**Keywords:** visual world models; JEPA; action-conditioned predictive consistency; visual robustness; predictive-dynamics diagnostics.

**Code and data release:** <https://github.com/Anguo-star/lewm-acpc-diagnostics>

## 1 Introduction

JEPAs predict future representations instead of reconstructing pixels, which can reduce pressure to encode high-magnitude irrelevant visual detail [1, 3, 29]. For control, however, “irrelevant” is action- and transition-dependent. A representation may ignore a background texture but must preserve a contact pose, doorway state, or object-goal relation if that distinction changes the next useful action. Encoder-level invariance is therefore an incomplete robustness target: planning uses the model’s *predictions*, so the robustness question should be asked after action-conditioned rollout.

We study this gap as a controlled diagnostic problem for JEPA latent world-model control. Let a clean history and a visually perturbed history describe the same underlying state, and evaluate both branches under the same action sequence. The desired behavior is not necessarily identical encoder latents. It is that task-relevant predicted futures agree after the shared action intervention, while states that differ in action, transition, cost, or goal relation remain separable. This selective requirement is the core of action-conditioned predictive consistency (ACPC).

The selective tension matters because consistency alone can be misleading. A collapsed model can make clean and corrupted views agree while erasing distinctions needed for planning. Conversely, a large encoder shift can be harmless if the action-conditioned predictor contracts nuisance directions before they affect the predicted rollout used by planning. The diagnostic must therefore pair a same-state predictive-stability metric with an anti-collapse margin check for task-grounded near-boundary separations.

We instantiate this diagnostic with a fixed Gaussian intervention. Across PushT, TwoRoom, Reacher, and Cube, we evaluate no-noise LeWM [19] checkpoints and full-sequence input-side Gaussian-noise checkpoints over  $\sigma_{\max} \in \{0.01, \dots, 0.08\}$ . The primary endpoint is observation-only Gaussian evaluation noise with the goal image kept clean. Across three independent LeWM training seeds, the no-noise baseline remains strong on clean observations but loses  $74.56 \pm 5.55$  points on PushT and  $41.00 \pm 1.44$  points on Reacher at evaluation noise

$\sigma = 0.08$ . Test-time visual fragility is not new [15, 33, 12, 21]; our focus is what it reveals about fixed JEPA world-model checkpoints.

The evidence shows broad matched-Gaussian recovery plateaus rather than a stable universal point optimum. Input-side noise training recovers the observation-noise endpoint on TwoRoom, PushT, and Reacher and gives a weaker but positive Cube signal across training seeds. At recovered endpoints, ACPC Tail Risk (ATR) is substantially lower and Selective Margin Pass Rate (SMPR) is near one across tasks. Bounded blur/resize checks delimit perturbation scope.

This paper makes three contributions. First, it formulates visual robustness for JEPA world-model control as selective action-conditioned predictive consistency rather than encoder invariance. Second, it derives an ACPC radius–margin diagnostic certificate: high-probability same-state predictive radius, planner candidate margins, and task-grounded discriminability margins jointly bound fixed-pool candidate instability and collapse risk. ATR and SMPR are empirical estimates of the two sides of this certificate. Third, it provides a fixed-checkpoint Gaussian robustness study across four tasks and three LeWM training seeds, with bounded unseen-stressor checks that delimit the perturbation scope.

## 2 Related Work

This diagnostic sits between latent-prediction representation learning and robust visual-control methods. The related work is organized around three questions: what latent prediction promises, where augmentation-based invariance is insufficient for control, and how control-relevant representation work treats downstream predictive consequences.

### 2.1 Latent prediction and JEPA world models

JEPA [16] predicts in latent space rather than reconstructing pixels; I-JEPA [1] and the V-JEPA family [3, 2, 20] extend this idea to images, video, and dense physical-world representations. LeWM [19], our baseline, stabilizes an end-to-end JEPA world model with SIGReg [6]. PLDM [25, 26], via `stable-worldmodel` [18], provides related latent-dynamics planning context. LeJEPA theory [14] studies latent-variable recovery and latent planning; our diagnostic asks whether learned visual world-model checkpoints give paired clean/noised views consistent action-conditioned predictions.

### 2.2 Invariance, augmentation, and visual robustness

Augmentation and joint-embedding losses impose invariances only when their training signal identifies the right nuisance factors [31, 27, 35]. Recent theory clarifies why latent prediction can help with nuisance or noisy features but also why it is not enough for control. Van Assel et al. [29] and Littwin et al. [17] analyze representation-level effects; they do not address closed-loop action-conditioned rollout, candidate-cost stability, or the need to keep action-distinct states separable. Seq-JEPA [8] addresses a related invariance–equivariance tension architecturally.

We do not train robust visual-control systems as competing baselines. DrQ/DrQ-v2 [15, 33], SODA/DMC-GB [12], DreamerV3 [10], TD-MPC2 [11], and ViGMO [21] define future method-comparison axes; noisy/video JEPA variants [22, 13, 23] are representation-level context. ACPC is complementary: it tests whether same-state visual perturbations become equivalent after a fixed action intervention while action-, transition-, or cost-distinct cases remain discriminable.

### 2.3 Control-relevant predictive representations

Bisimulation merges states with equivalent reward and transition behavior. DeepMDP [7], DBC [34], bisimulation-regularized MPC [24], and Bisim-JEPA [28] use this principle to learn control-relevant representations. Value-equivalent and value-aware models [9, 30] and VIBR [5] likewise emphasize downstream control consequences. Wang et al. [32] formalize action-conditioned video world modeling as a group action with identity, inverse, and composition-consistency metrics. ReOI [4] treats visual distractor robustness in visual MPC through observation interventions for world-model action-outcome prediction. These lines show that downstream predictive consequences are already central to control-representation work. Our diagnostic instantiates that view for paired clean/noised JEPA latent-world-model rollouts: same-state noised and unperturbed views should agree after the same action sequence, while action-distinct transitions remain separable.

Our use of ACPC is therefore narrower than an identifiability theorem, a learned bisimulation metric, or a robust MPC intervention. LeJEPA-style results motivate latent prediction and planning under latent recovery assumptions; bisimulation and value-aware models define task abstractions; group-action metrics test action faithfulness; ReOI modifies observation handling for robust visual MPC. This paper instead supplies a JEPA checkpoint diagnostic centered on additive Gaussian pixel-noise stress tests: predictive stability is tested on paired same-state clean/noised rollouts under the same action sequence, fixed-candidate cost stability is derived as a sufficient condition, and a separate discriminability guard checks that action-, transition-, or cost-distinct cases have not been collapsed.

### 3 Action-Conditioned Predictive Consistency

This section defines action-conditioned predictive consistency and its discriminability guard. We use ACPC to separate two requirements that encoder invariance alone conflates: same-state visual perturbations should agree after action-conditioned rollout, while task-grounded different-state pairs should remain separable. Section 3.3 then maps these two requirements to ATR and SMPR.

#### 3.1 Setup and definitions

Let  $o_t$  be an unperturbed observation and  $\tilde{o}_t = \tau(o_t)$  a visually perturbed view of the *same* underlying state ( $\tau$  is additive Gaussian pixel noise here, but the definitions are perturbation-agnostic). Let  $h_t$  and  $\tilde{h}_t$  be the corresponding observation-action histories,  $E_\theta$  the encoder, and  $F_\theta$  the action-conditioned latent predictor. Fix an action sequence  $\mathbf{a}_t^H = a_{t:t+H-1}$  that is *identical* on both branches. For compact notation below,  $\mathbf{a}_{0:k-1}$  denotes the length- $k$  prefix of this sequence after re-indexing time at  $t$ , and we write

$$z_t = E_\theta(h_t), \quad \tilde{z}_t = E_\theta(\tilde{h}_t), \quad \hat{z}_{t+k} = F_\theta^k(z_t, \mathbf{a}_{0:k-1}), \quad \hat{\tilde{z}}_{t+k} = F_\theta^k(\tilde{z}_t, \mathbf{a}_{0:k-1}). \quad (1)$$

Let  $\Pi$  denote a *task-relevant predictive projection* — the full latent, a transition delta, goal-distance or cost features, or a learned projection — and let  $d$  be a distance on its range.

**Action-conditioned predictive consistency.** For a same-state perturbation pair under the shared action sequence,

$$\text{ACPC}_H(o_t, \tilde{o}_t, \mathbf{a}) = \sum_{k=1}^H \alpha_k d(\Pi(\hat{z}_{t+k}), \Pi(\hat{\tilde{z}}_{t+k})), \quad \alpha_k \geq 0. \quad (2)$$

For the theoretical statements below, we use the induced horizon metric

$$d_H((u_1, \dots, u_H), (v_1, \dots, v_H)) = \sum_{k=1}^H \alpha_k d(u_k, v_k), \quad (3)$$

so that Equation (2) is exactly the clean/perturbed projected-rollout distance under the shared action sequence. In this diagnostic framing, robustness corresponds to small  $\text{ACPC}_H$  together with action-relevant discriminability, not to the encoder distance  $d(z_t, \tilde{z}_t)$  alone. Encoder geometry remains an indispensable first-stage risk signal: noisy views should stay in the same-state predictive basin and avoid crossing into task-distinct neighborhoods. The narrower point is that raw encoder distance alone is not a complete robustness criterion, because the effect of an encoder shift depends on local action-conditioned rollout sensitivity and candidate margins.

**Action-relevant discriminability.** Consistency must be *selective*. Let  $Y^H(s, \mathbf{a})$  denote a task-relevant future signal that is external to the learned predictor — simulator state, cost-to-go, inverse-dynamics label, contact/keyframe tag, or another diagnostic proxy available in the dataset. For two genuinely different states  $s_i, s_j$  (with latents  $z_i, z_j$ ) that admit an action sequence under which this external future signal diverges,

$$\Delta_{\text{dyn}}^H(s_i, s_j, \mathbf{a}) = d_Y(Y^H(s_i, \mathbf{a}), Y^H(s_j, \mathbf{a})) > m, \quad (4)$$

the representation and predictions should keep them separable,

$$d(\Psi(z_i), \Psi(z_j)) > m', \quad (5)$$

where  $\Psi$  is a discriminability projection, possibly action-conditioned (latent, predicted delta under  $\mathbf{a}$ , inverse-dynamics feature, cost feature, or rollout embedding), and  $m, m' > 0$  are margins. Equations (2)–(5) state the target: lower predictive disagreement for same-state visual perturbations must preserve discriminability among state/action/transition-distinct pairs. A method that drove  $\text{ACPC}_H \rightarrow 0$  by collapsing the latent would violate (5), so the two conditions are inseparable.

The same guard can be posed over state-action pairs: if two pairs have external task-relevant futures that differ by more than a margin, their projected rollouts should remain separated. This includes the same clean state evaluated under two dynamically distinct actions. The reported SMPR instantiates the guard with task-grounded near-boundary state pairs rather than adding a separate action-faithfulness metric.

### 3.2 Predictive tubes and task margins

The selective condition can be written as a radius-margin event. For a fixed action sequence, define the projected rollout map

$$G_{\mathbf{a}}(z) = \Pi(F_{\theta}^{1:H}(z, \mathbf{a})) \quad (6)$$

and the same-state predictive radius under perturbation level  $\sigma$  as

$$R_{\sigma}(h, \mathbf{a}) = d_H(G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(h)), G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(\tilde{h}_{\sigma}))) , \quad r_{1-\alpha}(\sigma) = Q_{1-\alpha}(R_{\sigma}(h, \mathbf{a})). \quad (7)$$

The radius side asks whether a visual perturbation remains inside the same-state predictive tube after the action intervention. The margin side asks whether planner and task-grounded distinctions remain outside that tube. For a fixed candidate pool  $\mathcal{A}$ , the clean planner margin is

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{A}}(h, g) = C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(2)}, g) - C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, g), \quad (8)$$

where lower cost is preferred and  $\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, \mathbf{a}^{(2)}$  are the clean top-1 and top-2 candidates. For task-grounded different-state pairs, we write the discriminability margin as

$$M_{\text{diff}}(i, j, \mathbf{a}) = d(\Psi(z_i), \Psi(z_j)), \quad (9)$$

and track the failure event  $M_{\text{diff}} \leq R_{\sigma} + \delta_m$  for a reporting margin  $\delta_m \geq 0$ . Robustness requires both sides: small radius without margin is collapse, while large margin without small radius is visually unstable planning.

### 3.3 Operational consistency diagnostics

The reported diagnostic uses two metrics matched to this radius-margin logic. ACPC Tail Risk (ATR) estimates the upper quantile of the same-state predictive radius in Equation (7): it summarizes normalized clean/noisy ACPC-H rollout disagreement under a fixed recorded action sequence; lower is better. We use the 90th percentile in all experiments as a fixed empirical reporting choice, not a theoretical constant. Selective Margin Pass Rate (SMPR) estimates the margin-preservation side: it is the pass rate of task-grounded label-crossing pairs whose clean different-state rollout distance exceeds the same-state noisy radius at margin zero; higher is better.

The diagnostic gate is therefore not ATR alone. ATR tracks the high-tail term  $\Pr[D > \epsilon]$  in the sampled-pool tail argument, while SMPR estimates whether task-grounded near-boundary pairs remain outside the perturbation tube. Low ATR without high SMPR is not interpreted as robustness, because a collapsed encoder-predictor can also make clean and corrupted views agree. Encoder geometry and planner-side audits remain useful development checks, but the diagnostic used in this paper is the joint radius-margin event.

### 3.4 ACPC as a fixed-candidate stability condition

ACPC is connected to planning through the candidate costs evaluated by model-predictive control. Let  $h$  be a clean history,  $\tilde{h}$  the corresponding perturbed history, and let both branches evaluate the same candidate action sequence  $\mathbf{a}$ . For a goal or task descriptor  $g$ , define

$$C_h(\mathbf{a}, g) = J(\Pi(\hat{z}_{t+1}), \dots, \Pi(\hat{z}_{t+H}), g), \quad (10)$$

where  $J$  is the planner cost on the projected-rollout sequence.  $C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}, g)$  is defined analogously from the perturbed branch. The following statements are sufficient conditions for stability on a fixed candidate set; they do not prove stability of the full CEM sampling distribution or of the closed-loop trajectory over repeated replanning.

Encoder geometry enters the planning link through the composed rollout map

$$G_{\mathbf{a}}(z) = \Pi(F_{\theta}^{1:H}(z, \mathbf{a})).$$

Smaller same-state encoder shifts and reduced neighborhood crossing lower upstream risk, but the planning-relevant quantity is the projected-rollout distance after the shift is passed through  $G_{\mathbf{a}}$ . The empirical diagnostic therefore reports action-conditioned rollout-disagreement tails rather than raw encoder distances alone.

If the planner cost  $J$  is locally  $L_J$ -Lipschitz on a fixed clean/perturbed projected-rollout neighborhood, then a paired rollout discrepancy at most  $\epsilon$  implies candidate-cost drift at most  $L_J\epsilon$ :

$$d_H(\Pi(F_{\theta}^{1:H}(E_{\theta}(h), \mathbf{a})), \Pi(F_{\tilde{\theta}}^{1:H}(E_{\tilde{\theta}}(\tilde{h}), \mathbf{a}))) \leq \epsilon \quad \Rightarrow \quad |C_h(\mathbf{a}, g) - C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}, g)| \leq L_J\epsilon.$$

For a shared candidate set, if every candidate cost moves by at most  $\eta$  and the clean top-1/top-2 margin  $\Delta$  is larger than  $2\eta$ , the top candidate is unchanged. Equivalently, the ACPC-cost condition gives fixed-candidate stability when  $\Delta > 2L_J\epsilon$ . These are fixed-candidate statements only; adaptive sampling, repeated replanning, and environment feedback can still change the closed-loop trajectory. Formal statements and proofs are in Appendix A.

**Theorem 1** (ACPC radius–margin certificate). *Let  $\mathcal{A} = \{\mathbf{a}^1, \dots, \mathbf{a}^K\} \sim q^K$  be a once-sampled candidate pool with deterministic tie-breaking. For a clean history  $h$  and matched perturbed history  $\tilde{h}$ , define*

$$D_j = d_H(G_{\mathbf{a}^j}(E_{\theta}(h)), G_{\mathbf{a}^j}(E_{\tilde{\theta}}(\tilde{h}))).$$

*Assume the planner cost  $J$  is locally  $L_J$ -Lipschitz on the evaluated projected-rollout neighborhood and that for a single sampled candidate*

$$\Pr_{\mathbf{a} \sim q}[D(\mathbf{a}) > \epsilon] \leq \alpha.$$

*Let  $\Delta_{\mathcal{A}} = C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(2)}, g) - C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, g)$  be the clean top-1/top-2 candidate margin. Then*

$$\Pr_{\mathcal{A}} \left[ \arg \min_j C_h(\mathbf{a}^j, g) \neq \arg \min_j C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}^j, g) \right] \leq K\alpha + \Pr_{\mathcal{A}}[\Delta_{\mathcal{A}} \leq 2L_J\epsilon].$$

*If the task-grounded discriminability failure event satisfies*

$$\Pr[M_{\text{diff}} \leq R_{\sigma} + \delta_m] \leq \gamma,$$

*then the selective-ACPC diagnostic failure risk is controlled by*

$$\Pr[\text{selective failure}] \leq K\alpha + \Pr_{\mathcal{A}}[\Delta_{\mathcal{A}} \leq 2L_J\epsilon] + \gamma.$$

This is a diagnostic certificate for a fixed candidate pool and a matched perturbation distribution. It says that a checkpoint is in the safe radius–margin regime only when the high-probability same-state predictive radius is below the relevant planner margin and task-grounded separations remain outside the perturbation tube.

**Definition 1** (Matched-perturbation diagnostic interval). *For a checkpoint family indexed by training perturbation level  $\rho$  and evaluated at observation noise  $\sigma$ , define the empirical radius–margin pass event*

$$\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_{\rho, \sigma} = \left\{ \widehat{Q}_{1-\alpha}(R_{\sigma}) \leq \widehat{r}_{\text{margin}} \right\} \cap \left\{ \widehat{\text{SMPR}}_{\rho, \sigma} \geq 1 - \widehat{\gamma} \right\}.$$

*The matched-perturbation diagnostic interval is the set of checkpoint indices  $\rho$  for which  $\widehat{\mathcal{G}}_{\rho, \sigma}$  holds. If planner-margin traces are unavailable,  $\widehat{r}_{\text{margin}}$  must be reported as a task-grounded rollout-space proxy, not as a planner-margin certificate. If diagnostics are available only at the no-noise and recovered endpoints, the evidence is endpoint mechanism evidence rather than interval identification.*

### 3.5 Sampled-pool tail motivation and Gaussian sensitivity

The fixed-candidate statements motivate the deterministic link from paired rollout agreement to candidate decisions. A once-sampled candidate pool adds a tail requirement: if a single candidate has  $\Pr[D > \epsilon] \leq \delta$ , then a pool of size  $K$  can still contain a bad clean/noisy rollout pair with probability up to  $K\delta$ . A flip can also occur when the clean top-1/top-2 margin is at most  $2L_J\epsilon$ . This is the reason ATR uses an upper-tail summary rather than a mean disagreement score, and it is also why ATR is not a closed-loop control guarantee. Appendix A gives the proof.

The Gaussian stressor also has a local sensitivity interpretation. Let  $G_{\mathbf{a}}(z) = \Pi(F_{\theta}^{1:H}(z, \mathbf{a}))$  and let  $\tilde{o} = o + \xi$  with  $\xi \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I)$ .

**Proposition 1** (Local Gaussian ACPC sensitivity). *If  $E_{\theta}$  and  $G_{\mathbf{a}}$  are locally twice differentiable around  $o$  and  $E_{\theta}(o)$  with bounded second-order remainders, then for small  $\sigma$ ,*

$$G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(o + \xi)) - G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(o)) = J_{G_{\mathbf{a}}}(E_{\theta}(o))J_E(o)\xi + R_{\xi},$$

where the remainder contributes higher-order terms, and

$$\mathbb{E}_{\xi} \left[ \|G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(o + \xi)) - G_{\mathbf{a}}(E_{\theta}(o))\|_2^2 \right] = \sigma^2 \|J_{G_{\mathbf{a}}}(E_{\theta}(o))J_E(o)\|_F^2 + O(\sigma^3).$$

The same linearization gives the local tail interpretation used by ATR. Let

$$A_{h,\mathbf{a}} = J_{G_{\mathbf{a}}}(E_{\theta}(o))J_E(o).$$

Then  $R_{\sigma}^2(h, \mathbf{a}) \approx \|A_{h,\mathbf{a}}\xi\|_2^2$  with  $\xi \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2 I)$ . If  $A_{h,\mathbf{a}}A_{h,\mathbf{a}}^{\top}$  has eigenvalues  $\lambda_i$ , then

$$R_{\sigma}^2/\sigma^2 \approx \sum_i \lambda_i \chi_i^2, \quad Q_{1-\alpha}(R_{\sigma}) \approx \sigma \sqrt{Q_{1-\alpha} \left( \sum_i \lambda_i \chi_i^2 \right)}.$$

Combining this local radius quantile with the fixed-pool margin condition gives the diagnostic noise scale

$$\sigma^*(h, \mathbf{a}, \mathcal{A}) = \frac{\Delta_{\mathcal{A}}}{2L_J \sqrt{Q_{1-\alpha}(\sum_i \lambda_i \chi_i^2)}}.$$

This is a local diagnostic approximation, not a global robustness theorem. It clarifies why matched Gaussian training can lower ATR: it may reduce encoder-side neighborhood crossing, rollout-side amplification, or both.

Thus Gaussian ACPC measures action-conditioned encoder–predictor sensitivity, not encoder invariance alone. Noise training can improve robustness through both factors: it can reduce same-state encoder neighborhood crossing, and it can reduce the rollout sensitivity applied to any remaining encoder shift. Small encoder shifts can still be amplified by  $J_{G_{\mathbf{a}}}$ , while large nuisance shifts can become harmless after rollout if the product  $J_{G_{\mathbf{a}}}J_E$  is small in those directions. The selective target is therefore asymmetric: the product should be small along nuisance perturbation directions, while projected rollouts for action-relevant state differences remain separated. The task-grounded near-boundary proxy margin pass event used later is

$$M = \mathbf{1}[d_{\text{proxy diff}} > d_{\text{same state noise}} + \delta_m],$$

with  $\delta_m = 0$  in the reported table. It is a finite state-proxy selective-consistency check, not a full semantic-label coverage guarantee.

The theoretical statements in this section are intended as diagnostic orientation rather than as closed-loop control guarantees. They identify the failure modes that a paired clean/noisy diagnostic should measure: rollout-disagreement tails, clean candidate-margin caveats, and collapse of task-grounded separations. They do not assert that a low empirical ATR is a uniform bound for adaptive planning, repeated replanning, or environment-feedback stability.

**Collapse caveat.** Low same-state ACPC alone is insufficient. A constant encoder–predictor can make every clean and perturbed rollout identical while also mapping action-distinct states to identical projected futures. This is why SMPR is part of the reported diagnostic: ATR measures predictive stability under nuisance perturbation, and SMPR checks that task-grounded separations have not been erased.

## 4 Study protocol

The protocol separates behavior endpoints from diagnostics. Closed-loop success under Gaussian evaluation noise establishes the behavioral phenomenon; ATR and SMPR are then computed on fixed checkpoints to localize whether recovered endpoints also satisfy the selective ACPC pattern. Training seed, checkpoint epoch, evaluation seeds, and trajectory counts are kept fixed across the main comparisons.

### 4.1 Models and noise intervention

LeWM [19] is an end-to-end JEPA world model trained with a latent prediction loss and SIGReg regularization for latent-space model-predictive control. PushT (2D pushing), TwoRoom (2D navigation), Reacher (2D arm), and Cube (3D manipulation) form a heterogeneous stress panel spanning different nuisance/discriminability regimes. We add per-frame Gaussian noise to the input sequence as a full-sequence augmentation: each frame is independently noised with probability  $p = 1.0$ , and the standard deviation is drawn from  $\text{Uniform}(0, \sigma_{\max})$ . This is a full-sequence input-side augmentation. We sweep  $\sigma_{\max} \in \{0.01, \dots, 0.08\}$  and evaluate observation-only Gaussian noise with the goal image unperturbed as the primary robustness endpoint.

### 4.2 Evaluation and diagnostics

The canonical LeWM development grid contains 36 epoch-10 checkpoints for training seed 3072: four tasks and, for each task, a no-noise baseline plus eight noise-trained checkpoints. Each checkpoint is evaluated with three evaluation seeds (42/43/44) and 100 trajectories per seed; canonical tables report the population mean  $\pm$  population std across those three evaluation seeds. A completed Gaussian training-seed replication adds independent LeWM training seeds 3073 and 3074 under the same nine-point Gaussian sweep and evaluation protocol. Together, seed 3072 plus replication seeds 3073/3074 provide three training seeds for the main Gaussian closed-loop endpoint in Figure 1.

The main results follow a two-part evidence chain. Closed-loop figures and tables report training-seed mean/std for Gaussian robustness. ATR measures whether same-state clean/noisy rollout-disagreement tails contract at recovered endpoints, and SMPR checks whether task-grounded near-boundary separations survive that contraction. Unseen-stressor scores are auxiliary scope checks rather than additional core diagnostics.

## 5 Experiments

The experiments use additive Gaussian pixel noise as the primary controlled stressor for a representation-diagnostic question. We first show that the stressor changes closed-loop behavior. We then ask where recovery appears in the model, prioritizing cross-task ACPC/paired-rollout evidence and keeping task-specific representation measurements only as discriminability checks. The study is a matched-stressor trace through the encoder–predictor–planner chain; checkpoint ranking, external method comparison, and broad perturbation-family transfer are outside its scope.

All results use the protocol in Section 4: LeWM-base denotes the no-noise checkpoint, and LeWM+noise denotes the eight-level  $\sigma_{\max}$  sweep.

### 5.1 JEPA control fragility under Gaussian observation noise

Table 1 reports LeWM-base success rates under observation-only Gaussian evaluation noise. Each training-seed value is first averaged over the three evaluation seeds; the table reports mean  $\pm$  population std across the three training seeds. The goal image is kept clean in every column.

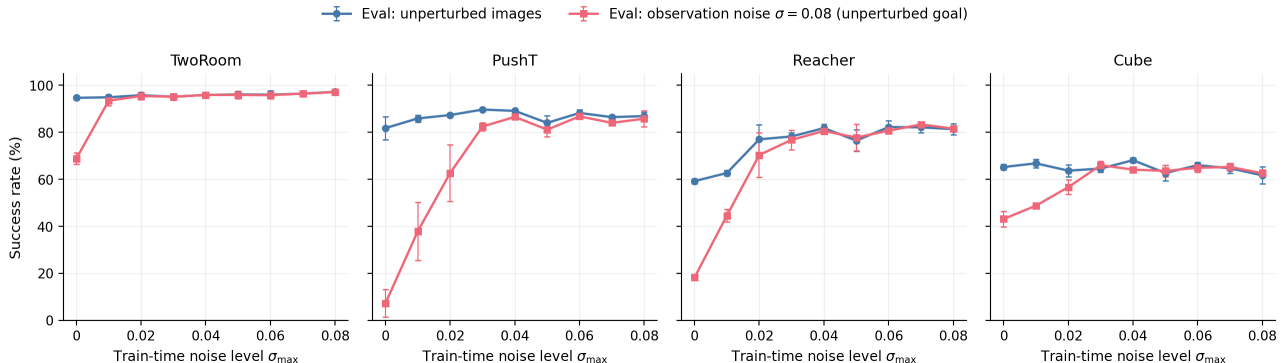
**Table 1:** LeWM-base under observation-only Gaussian evaluation noise. Values are mean  $\pm$  population std across training seeds 3072/3073/3074; each training-seed value averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44 with 100 trajectories per evaluation seed. The goal image is kept clean.

| Task    | eval $\sigma = 0$ | eval $\sigma = 0.03$ | eval $\sigma = 0.05$ | eval $\sigma = 0.08$ |
|---------|-------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| TwoRoom | $94.67 \pm 0.72$  | $92.56 \pm 1.23$     | $81.33 \pm 6.77$     | $68.78 \pm 2.45$     |
| PushT   | $81.78 \pm 4.89$  | $53.56 \pm 12.91$    | $19.22 \pm 9.12$     | $7.22 \pm 5.81$      |
| Reacher | $59.22 \pm 1.03$  | $42.56 \pm 2.99$     | $33.56 \pm 1.77$     | $18.22 \pm 0.42$     |
| Cube    | $65.22 \pm 1.10$  | $63.00 \pm 1.19$     | $46.67 \pm 1.96$     | $43.11 \pm 3.27$     |

LeWM-base is strong on unperturbed images, but observation noise alone produces large closed-loop losses at  $\sigma = 0.08$ : PushT loses  $74.56 \pm 5.55$  points, Reacher  $41.00 \pm 1.44$  points, TwoRoom  $25.89 \pm 2.38$  points, and Cube  $22.11 \pm 2.78$  points between the first and last columns. The progression across noise levels is smooth enough to show that the endpoint is not an isolated artifact of one severity setting. PushT degrades most sharply, consistent with contact-heavy continuous control being sensitive to visual precision.

## 5.2 Noise augmentation supplies recovered checkpoints for diagnosis

Figure 1 shows the full LeWM Gaussian sweep aggregated across training seeds 3072/3073/3074. Each plotted point first averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44 within a training seed and then reports mean and population std across the three training seeds. The main qualitative pattern is a broad, task-dependent recovery plateau rather than a stable universal checkpoint ranking.



**Figure 1:** Three-training-seed LeWM Gaussian sweep across four tasks. Each point averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44 within each training seed and then reports mean across training seeds 3072/3073/3074; error bars show population std across training seeds. Blue circles: unperturbed evaluation; red squares: observation-only Gaussian noise  $\sigma = 0.08$  with an unperturbed goal. The curves document broad task-dependent recovery plateaus rather than checkpoint rankings.

Because Figure 1 already aggregates the full sweep across three training seeds, we do not report a separate endpoint leaderboard in the main text. The fixed  $\sigma_{\max} = 0.08$  endpoint substantially improves the observation-noise endpoint on TwoRoom, PushT, and Reacher, with a weaker positive Cube signal. Exact all-seed sweep values are reported in Appendix C for reproducibility.

A three-seed blur/resize score check later in this section serves as an auxiliary severe-stressor check outside the matched-Gaussian endpoint. The next subsection asks whether the recovered Gaussian endpoints also move in the ATR/SMPR diagnostics.

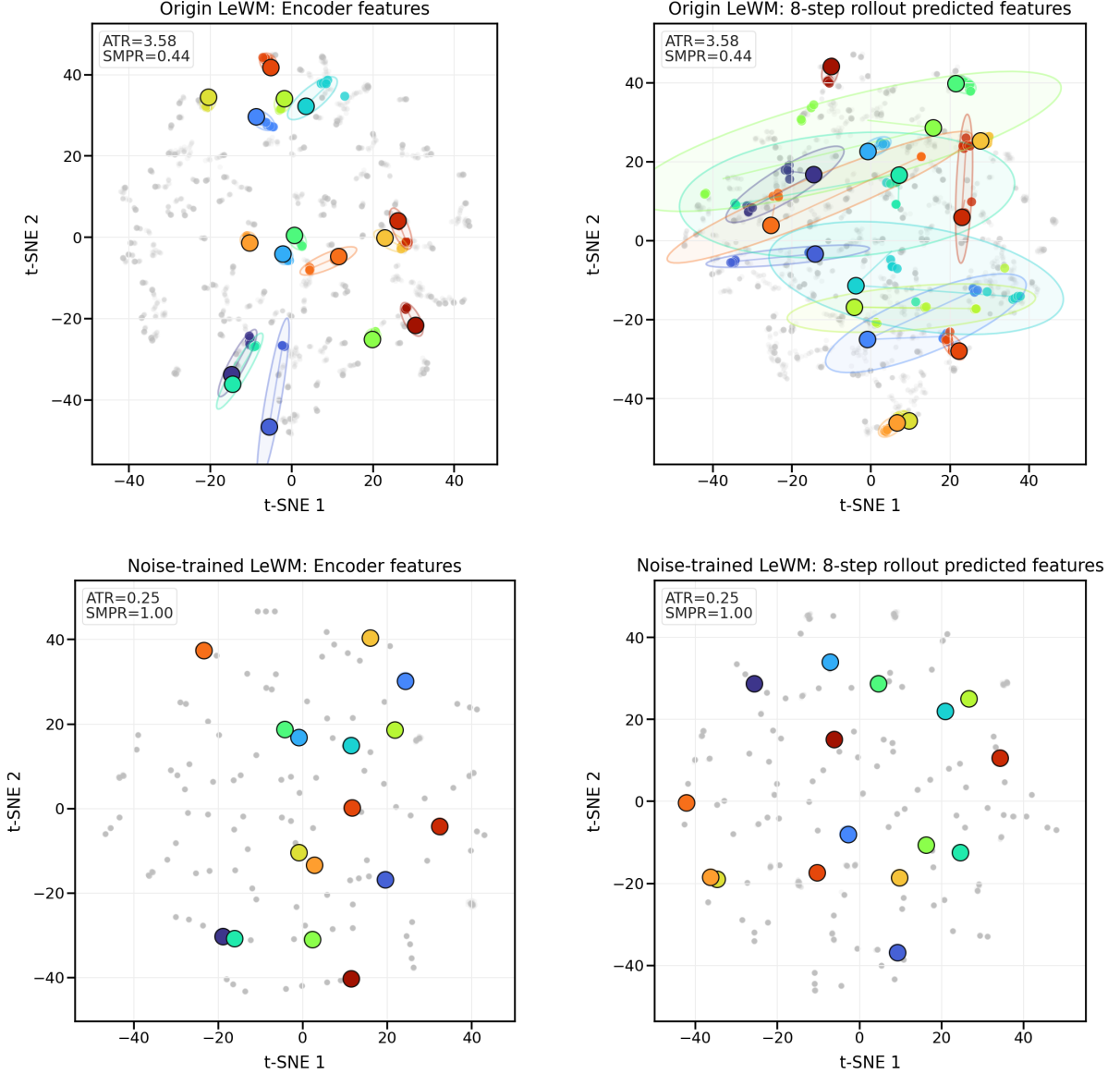
## 5.3 ATR/SMPR selective-ACPC diagnostics

For the main diagnostic, ATR is the 90th percentile of same-state clean/noisy ACPC-H rollout distance normalized by the clean transition scale. SMPR is the task-grounded near-boundary selective-margin pass rate at margin zero. Both are computed without retraining on the fixed no-noise and  $\sigma_{\max} = 0.08$  checkpoints for training seeds 3072/3073/3074. Table 2 reports population mean/std across training seeds.



**Table 2:** ATR/SMPR selective-ACPC diagnostics over training seeds 3072/3073/3074. ATR is the q90 normalized same-state clean/noisy action-conditioned rollout disagreement; lower is better. SMPR is the task-grounded near-boundary selective-margin pass rate; higher is better.

| Task    | ATR base          | ATR std0.08       | SMPR base       | SMPR std0.08    |
|---------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| TwoRoom | $1.509 \pm 0.010$ | $0.111 \pm 0.016$ | $0.34 \pm 0.05$ | $0.99 \pm 0.01$ |
| PushT   | $3.580 \pm 0.260$ | $0.247 \pm 0.017$ | $0.44 \pm 0.17$ | $1.00 \pm 0.00$ |
| Reacher | $2.628 \pm 0.048$ | $0.082 \pm 0.005$ | $0.73 \pm 0.03$ | $1.00 \pm 0.00$ |
| Cube    | $2.320 \pm 0.045$ | $0.100 \pm 0.007$ | $0.45 \pm 0.03$ | $1.00 \pm 0.00$ |



**Figure 2:** Qualitative PushT ACPC neighborhood t-SNE visualization for the Origin LeWM versus  $\sigma_{\max} = 0.08$  noise-trained contrast. The four panels show encoder features and 8-step rollout predicted features for repeated same-state perturbation views; colored clusters mark fixed random anchors. The t-SNE projection is qualitative. ATR and SMPR are the quantitative diagnostics and are computed in the original projected-rollout diagnostic space.

The two diagnostics move in the intended selective direction on all four tasks: recovered endpoints have

much smaller same-state predictive tails and much higher task-grounded margin pass rates. Figure 2 provides qualitative visual intuition on PushT: repeated noisy views of the same state become tighter after noise training in both encoder features and 8-step rollout predicted-feature projections. We interpret this as encoder basin repair plus further predictive contraction of residual nuisance variation, while keeping the quantitative claim on ATR, SMPR, and closed-loop behavior rather than distances in the t-SNE plane. Cube remains the useful boundary case: ATR and SMPR improve strongly, but the closed-loop Gaussian recovery in Figure 1 is weaker than PushT or Reacher, so closed-loop evaluation remains the behavioral authority.

SMPR uses programmatic task-state proxy labels, not oracle semantic annotations: TwoRoom uses doorway/room-side labels, PushT uses T-block pose cells, Reacher uses target/end-effector relation bins, and Cube uses cube-pose/goal-relation cells. Each anchor selects the closest label-crossing neighbor inside the closest 35% state-distance neighborhood and passes if that clean different-state rollout distance exceeds the same-state noisy radius. The no-noise baselines are weak under this stricter audit, while the high-noise endpoint reaches near-one pass rate; stronger hand-labeled or simulator-derived contact, topology, action-value, or cost-to-go labels remain future validation.

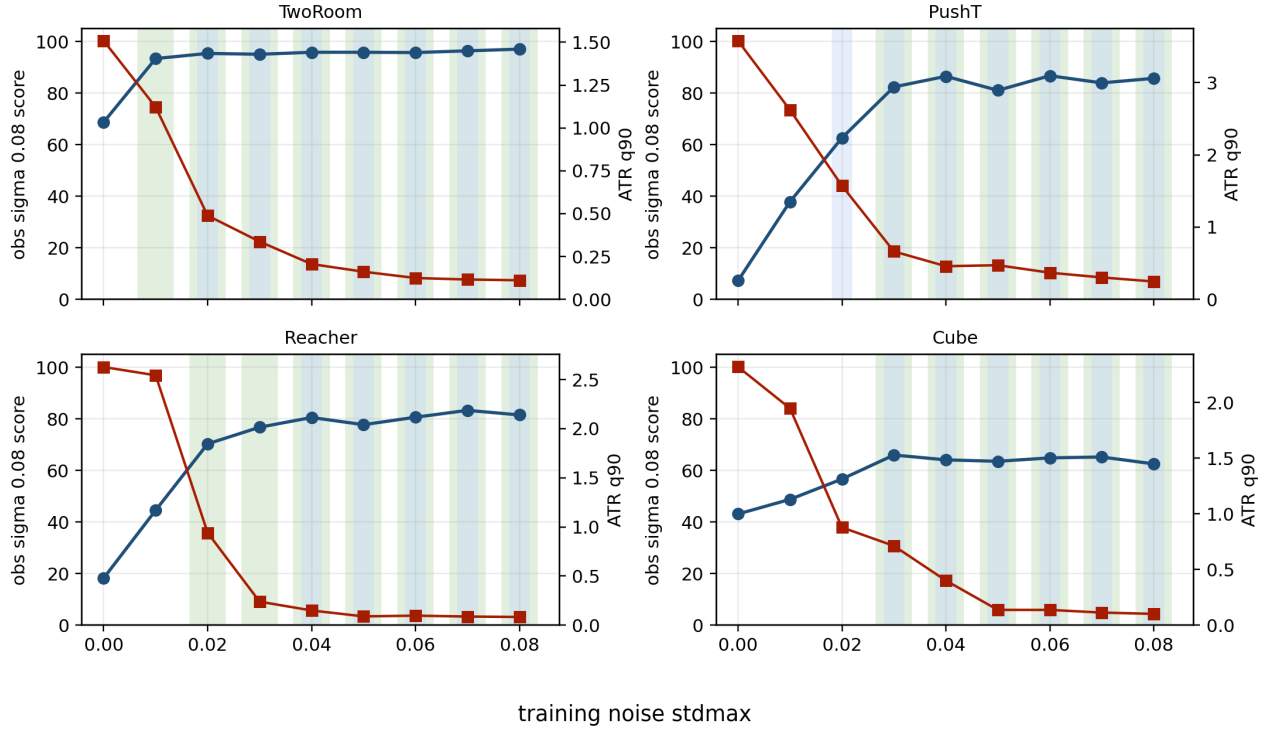
#### 5.4 Diagnostic validation of the radius–margin certificate

The radius–margin theory predicts that a checkpoint should be diagnostically robust when the high-tail same-state predictive radius is contained within the relevant planner or task-discriminability margin. We therefore add a training-free full-sweep validation using existing three-training-seed evaluation and diagnostic summaries. The behavioral plateau is defined only from closed-loop observation-noise scores: a checkpoint is marked as plateau if its observation-only  $\sigma = 0.08$  success is at least 80% of the way from the no-noise baseline to the maximum grid value for that task, while clean success stays within 5 points of the no-noise clean score. The diagnostic proxy is computed independently from fixed-pool diagnostic summaries as

$$\hat{\Gamma}_{\rho,0.08} = \hat{Q}_{0.50}(\Delta_{\mathcal{A}}) - 2\hat{Q}_{0.90}(|C_h - C_{\bar{h}}|).$$

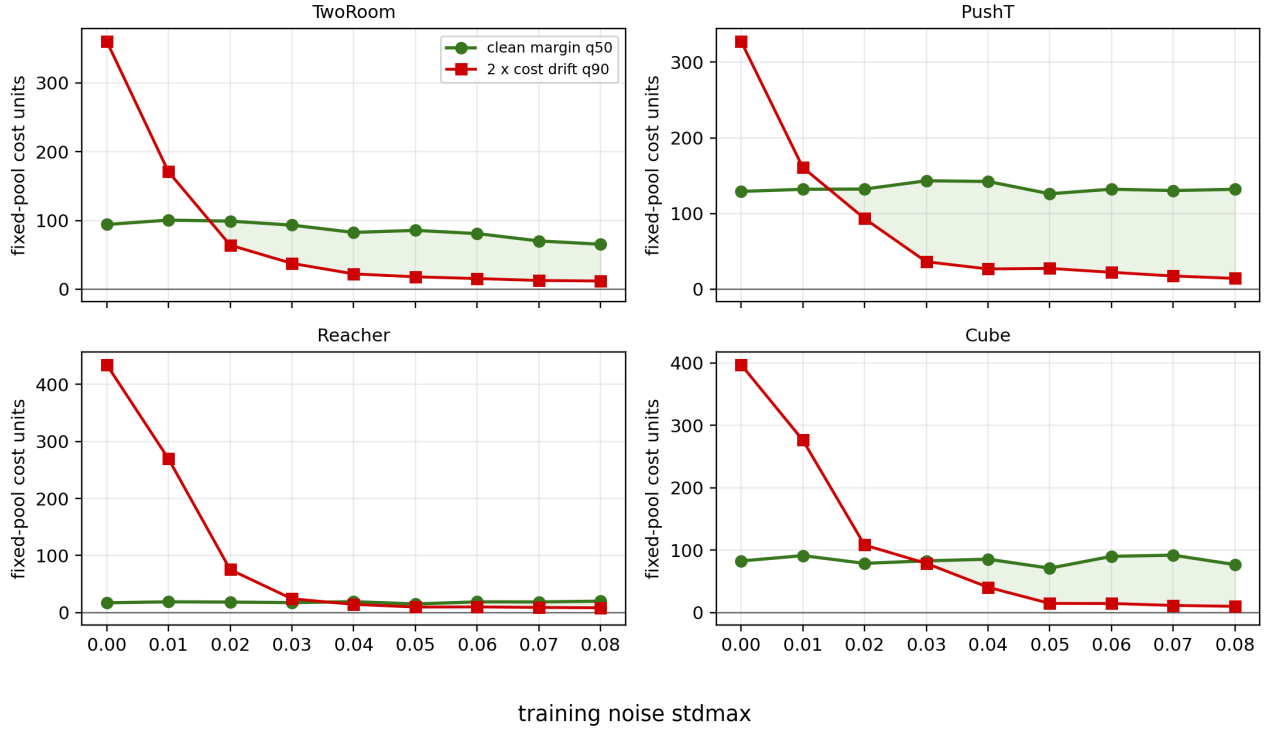
A positive proxy gap is the available empirical counterpart of the fixed-pool margin condition. Because the recorded summaries contain median clean candidate margin and q90 paired cost drift rather than the q10/q95 theorem quantities, we call it a fixed-pool proxy and not a planner-margin certificate. Appendix B.1 reports the fixed-pool candidate count and the plateau/proxy ranges used to interpret this diagnostic.

Radius-margin proxy interval vs Gaussian recovery plateau



**Figure 3:** Diagnostic validation of the radius-margin proxy against the Gaussian recovery plateau. Green bands mark behavioral plateau points defined only from closed-loop observation-noise scores; blue bands mark positive fixed-pool proxy gaps computed from fixed-pool diagnostic summaries. ATR is overlaid as the same-state radius-tail side. The shaded diagnostic interval is derived from diagnostic statistics only; the behavioral plateau is shown after the fact for alignment. This is a diagnostic validation, not a new checkpoint-selection algorithm.

### Fixed-pool cost-margin proxy overlap



**Figure 4:** Fixed-pool radius–margin overlap proxy across the full Gaussian training sweep. Curves compare the clean candidate–margin median with twice the q90 paired cost drift; positive separation supports the radius–margin condition in the available fixed-pool diagnostic summaries. This is a proxy rather than a planner–margin certificate because candidate–cost traces are summarized by available q50/q90 fields, not by the q10/q95 theorem quantities, and the sampled pool is fixed rather than adaptive CEM.

The proxy aligns with the broad recovery interval but does not exactly reproduce it. TwoRoom and PushT cross the proxy gap near the start of their high-score intervals, Cube aligns over the same broad range, and Reacher shows early behavioral recovery before the cost–margin proxy becomes positive. This is the expected level of evidence for a diagnostic certificate: it explains the radius–margin mechanism behind the existing plateau without replacing closed-loop evaluation. To keep the fixed-pool cost–margin proxy separate from a checkpoint-selection claim, we do not turn this overlay into a radius–margin ATR/SMPR gate table. As a separate no-retraining diagnostic-region audit, we group each task–training-seed sweep by normalized closed-loop recovery instead of by a universal  $\sigma_{\max}$  value or a threshold-classifier score. On held-out seeds 3073/3074, fragile checkpoints remain at high normalized ATR (median 1.00) and lower SMPR (median 0.43), transition checkpoints lie between the endpoints, and robust checkpoints occupy a shared low-ATR/high-SMPR region (median normalized ATR 0.087, median SMPR 1.00). Across all eight held-out task–seed blocks, the robust median has lower normalized ATR and higher SMPR than the fragile median. This supports ATR/SMPR as a task-conditioned diagnostic region for robust-vs-fragile separation and direction consistency; closed-loop evaluation remains the behavioral authority.

## 5.5 Bounded unseen-stressor check

The main evidence remains the matched Gaussian-noise endpoint. After freezing the Gaussian grid, we ran strongest-severity unseen-stressor score checks to test whether the fixed  $\sigma_{\max} = 0.08$  endpoint transfers outside the training perturbation family. Table 3 reports the non-Gaussian behavior together with stressor-specific ATR/SMPR diagnostics recomputed under the same blur or resize perturbation. TwoRoom and Reacher improve under strongest blur, whereas PushT and Cube do not show a clear resize gain at the scale of training-seed and evaluation variance. We treat this as bounded behavior outside the matched Gaussian setting.

**Table 3:** Bounded unseen-stressor score check with stressor-specific ATR/SMPR diagnostics. Score values are mean  $\pm$  population std across LeWM training seeds 3072/3073/3074; each seed point averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44 from strongest-severity unseen runs. The ATR and SMPR columns report raw no-noise  $\rightarrow$  noise-trained diagnostic values under the row stressor; lower ATR and higher SMPR are better.

| Task    | evaluation stressor | no-noise score    | noise-trained score | ATR                     | SMPR                    |
|---------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| TwoRoom | blur $k = 15$       | $47.67 \pm 5.44$  | $90.78 \pm 5.38$    | $1.61 \rightarrow 1.24$ | $0.16 \rightarrow 0.77$ |
| Reacher | blur $k = 15$       | $22.00 \pm 3.78$  | $71.22 \pm 1.10$    | $2.81 \rightarrow 0.54$ | $0.60 \rightarrow 0.98$ |
| PushT   | resize 0.25         | $63.44 \pm 14.05$ | $66.33 \pm 8.38$    | $1.77 \rightarrow 1.53$ | $0.93 \rightarrow 0.96$ |
| Cube    | resize 0.25         | $57.00 \pm 1.96$  | $56.11 \pm 0.57$    | $1.35 \rightarrow 1.59$ | $0.98 \rightarrow 0.95$ |

The raw unseen diagnostics co-move with behavior at this severe-stressor scale. The blur rows combine large behavior gains with lower ATR and higher SMPR after noise training; PushT resize has only small score and diagnostic movement; Cube resize is neutral to slightly negative on behavior and also moves in the wrong diagnostic direction. These rows therefore support only a bounded severe-stressor association rather than a general perturbation-transfer claim.

## 6 Discussion and limitations

**What the evidence supports.** This is a controlled diagnostic study, not a method paper. Closed-loop evaluation establishes the behavior; ATR checks whether same-state noisy views have small action-conditioned predictive tails; SMPR checks whether task-grounded near-boundary distinctions survive that contraction. The radius-margin overlay adds an independent fixed-pool cost-margin proxy over the Gaussian grid; mismatches are reported as diagnostic limits rather than hidden by the endpoint result. The primary statistic is the full three-training-seed Gaussian replication, with evaluation-seed variance kept as the within-seed measurement scale. These standard deviations are descriptive over three training seeds, not asymptotic significance claims.

**Scope.** Gaussian pixel noise remains the training/evaluation axis. The blur/resize rows are bounded behavior outside the matched Gaussian setting, not a transfer theorem. The radius-margin certificate is fixed-pool and matched-perturbation only: it does not cover adaptive CEM resampling, repeated replanning, or environment-feedback trajectory guarantees. The Gaussian quantile expression is a local linearization, and the empirical diagnostic interval is an audit view over available summaries rather than a closed-loop guarantee. ATR/SMPR are not a checkpoint-ranker for  $\sigma_{\max}$  and do not replace closed-loop evaluation inside a broad plateau. We do not claim superiority over DrQ-style augmentation, TD-MPC2, DreamerV3, or robust MPC methods; the contribution is a no-retraining diagnostic for JEPA latent world-model checkpoints under a controlled Gaussian stressor.

**What remains.** The results argue against a too-strong reading of latent prediction: future-latent prediction alone does not guarantee closed-loop visual robustness. Stronger discriminability evidence would require hand-labeled or simulator-derived contact, topology, action-value, or cost-to-go labels, especially for PushT and Cube. Future methods can turn ATR/SMPR into objectives, but this paper keeps that as a separate method-paper path after diagnostic validity is established.

## 7 Conclusion

This paper frames Gaussian-noise robustness in JEPA latent world-model control as a selective diagnostic problem. Closed-loop behavior establishes the phenomenon; ATR measures same-state predictive-stability tails; SMPR checks task-grounded anti-collapse margins. On fixed LeWM checkpoints, input-side noise training recovers broad matched-Gaussian robustness plateaus across three training seeds, and ATR/SMPR move in the expected direction at recovered endpoints.

The theory is deliberately diagnostic: sampled-pool ACPC exposes why tail risk matters and why clean margins prevent closed-loop guarantees, while local Gaussian linearization connects the measured tail to action-conditioned encoder-predictor sensitivity. The resulting view is a radius-margin diagnostic theory for fixed-checkpoint Gaussian robustness: ATR estimates the perturbation-tube radius tail, SMPR estimates margin preservation,

and their conjunction defines the empirical diagnostic interval studied here. The broader implication is not solved generalization; it is a concrete audit target for future methods: stable action-conditioned predictive dynamics under nuisance variation, while preserving distinctions needed for planning.

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## A Proofs for ACPC Diagnostics

These proofs support the diagnostic use of ATR and SMPR; they do not provide closed-loop control guarantees.

**Proposition 2** (ACPC controls candidate-cost drift). *Assume that  $J$  is locally  $L_J$ -Lipschitz on the clean/perturbed projected-rollout neighborhood evaluated by the fixed candidate set under metric  $d_H$ . If*

$$d_H(\Pi(F_\theta^{1:H}(E_\theta(h), \mathbf{a})), \Pi(F_\theta^{1:H}(E_\theta(\tilde{h}), \mathbf{a}))) \leq \epsilon,$$

then

$$|C_h(\mathbf{a}, g) - C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}, g)| \leq L_J \epsilon.$$

*Proof.* The planner cost  $J$  is  $L_J$ -Lipschitz on the projected-rollout sequence, so the cost difference is bounded by  $L_J$  times the clean/perturbed projected-rollout distance.  $\square$

**Proposition 3** (Candidate top-1 stability). *Let  $\mathcal{A} = \{\mathbf{a}^1, \dots, \mathbf{a}^K\}$  be the shared candidate set. Assume lower cost is preferred, and let  $\mathbf{a}^{(1)}$  and  $\mathbf{a}^{(2)}$  denote the lowest- and second-lowest-cost candidates on the clean branch. Suppose that for every candidate  $j$ ,*

$$|C_h(\mathbf{a}^j, g) - C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}^j, g)| \leq \eta.$$

*If the clean branch has a strict top-1/top-2 margin*

$$\Delta = C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(2)}, g) - C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, g) > 2\eta,$$

*then the perturbed branch selects the same top-1 candidate.*

*Proof.* For any candidate  $\mathbf{a}^j \neq \mathbf{a}^{(1)}$ ,

$$C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}^j, g) - C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, g) \geq C_h(\mathbf{a}^j, g) - C_h(\mathbf{a}^{(1)}, g) - 2\eta \geq \Delta - 2\eta > 0.$$

Thus every non-top candidate remains more costly than the clean top-1 candidate on the perturbed branch.  $\square$

### Proof of Theorem 1.

*Proof.* Let  $\mathcal{B} = \{\max_{1 \leq j \leq K} D_j \leq \epsilon\}$ . Since each candidate is drawn from  $q$  and a single draw has tail probability at most  $\alpha$ , the union bound gives

$$\Pr_{\mathcal{A}}(\mathcal{B}^c) \leq \sum_{j=1}^K \Pr[D_j > \epsilon] \leq K\alpha.$$

On  $\mathcal{B}$ , local Lipschitzness of the planner cost gives  $|C_h(\mathbf{a}^j, g) - C_{\tilde{h}}(\mathbf{a}^j, g)| \leq L_J \epsilon$  for every candidate. By the top-1 stability proposition, the perturbed branch can choose a different top candidate on  $\mathcal{B}$  only when  $\Delta_{\mathcal{A}} \leq 2L_J \epsilon$ . Therefore the top-1 flip event is contained in

$$\mathcal{B}^c \cup \{\Delta_{\mathcal{A}} \leq 2L_J \epsilon\},$$

which yields the fixed-pool instability bound without any independence assumption beyond the single-candidate tail statement. For the selective diagnostic statement, let  $\mathcal{D} = \{M_{\text{diff}} \leq R_\sigma + \delta_m\}$ . Selective failure is contained in the union of the fixed-pool planning-instability event and  $\mathcal{D}$ . Applying the union bound again and using  $\Pr(\mathcal{D}) \leq \gamma$  gives the final bound.  $\square$

**Local Gaussian sensitivity.** For small Gaussian pixel noise  $\xi$ , a first-order expansion gives  $E_\theta(o + \xi) = E_\theta(o) + J_E(o)\xi + \mathcal{R}(\xi)$  with  $\|\mathcal{R}(\xi)\| = O(\|\xi\|^2)$ . Composing the encoder with the action-conditioned rollout map shows that same-state rollout disagreement measures local sensitivity of the encoder–predictor composition, not encoder invariance alone. ATR reports a high-quantile version of that paired rollout disagreement.

## B Experimental Details

These details define the fixed evaluation and diagnostic protocol used by the main tables.

LeWM is evaluated on PushT, TwoRoom, Reacher, and Cube using the canonical three evaluation seeds 42/43/44 and 100 trajectories per seed. The main Gaussian robustness endpoint perturbs observation pixels with Gaussian noise at standard deviation 0.08 while keeping the goal image clean. Noise-trained checkpoints use full-sequence input-side Gaussian augmentation with  $\sigma_{\max} \in \{0.01, \dots, 0.08\}$ .

ATR is computed at each task–training-seed–checkpoint row as the 90th percentile same-state ACPC-H distance normalized by the clean transition scale. SMPR uses task-grounded near-boundary proxy labels at margin zero. The paper reports population mean/std across training seeds 3072/3073/3074.

### B.1 Radius–margin parameter interpretation

Theorem 1 separates the quantities needed for a numerical fixed-pool certificate from the lower-sample diagnostic summaries reported in the experiments. In the fixed-pool diagnostic summaries used for Figures 3 and 4, the candidate count is  $K = 65$  for every task–checkpoint row. The theorem’s single-candidate tail probability  $\alpha$  is not fixed by the q90 reporting level used by ATR. A q90 summary descriptively leaves 10% of recorded same-state radii above the reported quantile, but that descriptive exceedance rate is not the  $\alpha$  used in the theorem. If it were naively inserted into the union-bound term, the result would be  $65 \times 0.1 = 6.5$ , which is vacuous. A non-vacuous numerical candidate-flip bound would require a much smaller single-candidate tail probability or a different concentration argument. We therefore use q90 ATR and the q50/q90 cost-margin overlap as diagnostic evidence for the radius–margin mechanism, not as a calibrated probability guarantee.

**Table 4:** Fixed-pool radius–margin interpretation used in the diagnostic validation. The behavioral plateau is defined from closed-loop observation-only  $\sigma = 0.08$  scores; the proxy-positive range uses  $\widehat{Q}_{0.50}(\Delta_{\mathcal{A}}) - 2\widehat{Q}_{0.90}(|C_h - C_{\bar{h}}|) > 0$  on the recorded fixed-pool summaries. These ranges explain the overlay in Figure 3; they are not used to claim a calibrated flip-probability certificate.

| Task    | $K$ | behavioral plateau | proxy-positive range | interpretation                                     |
|---------|-----|--------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| TwoRoom | 65  | 0.01–0.08          | 0.02–0.08            | proxy misses the first plateau checkpoint          |
| PushT   | 65  | 0.03–0.08          | 0.02–0.08            | proxy includes one earlier checkpoint              |
| Reacher | 65  | 0.02–0.08          | 0.04–0.08            | proxy is conservative at low noise-training levels |
| Cube    | 65  | 0.03–0.08          | 0.03–0.08            | proxy and plateau ranges align                     |

In this interpretation,  $\beta_{\text{plan}}$  is the empirical chance that the clean top-1/top-2 fixed-pool margin is too small relative to the cost drift, and  $\beta_{\text{disc}}$  is the chance that task-grounded different-state separations fall inside the perturbation tube. The experiments estimate the planning side with available fixed-pool margin summaries and estimate the discriminability side with SMPR. The table intentionally reports only the cost-margin proxy interval and the closed-loop behavioral plateau interval, because it explains the fixed-pool radius–margin overlay rather than converting the separate ATR/SMPR diagnostic-region audit into a threshold-classifier claim.

## C Additional Gaussian Evaluation Tables

These tables report the full observation-only Gaussian evaluation columns available for the three-training-seed sweep behind Figure 1. Each training-seed value first averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44; table cells report mean  $\pm$  population std across training seeds 3072/3073/3074.

**Table 5:** Full three-training-seed LeWM observation-only Gaussian sweep evaluation table. Columns report clean evaluation and observation-only Gaussian evaluation at  $\sigma = 0.03/0.05/0.08$  with a clean goal image. Values are mean  $\pm$  population std across training seeds 3072/3073/3074; each training-seed value first averages evaluation seeds 42/43/44 with 100 trajectories per evaluation seed.

| Task    | training $\sigma_{\max}$ | clean eval       | obs-only $\sigma = 0.03$ eval | obs-only $\sigma = 0.05$ eval | obs-only $\sigma = 0.08$ eval |
|---------|--------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| TwoRoom | 0.00                     | 94.67 $\pm$ 0.72 | 92.56 $\pm$ 1.23              | 81.33 $\pm$ 6.77              | 68.78 $\pm$ 2.45              |
| TwoRoom | 0.01                     | 94.89 $\pm$ 1.10 | 95.00 $\pm$ 0.82              | 94.78 $\pm$ 1.77              | 93.44 $\pm$ 2.08              |
| TwoRoom | 0.02                     | 95.78 $\pm$ 1.10 | 95.89 $\pm$ 1.29              | 95.22 $\pm$ 1.29              | 95.44 $\pm$ 1.57              |
| TwoRoom | 0.03                     | 95.11 $\pm$ 0.87 | 95.00 $\pm$ 0.82              | 95.22 $\pm$ 0.83              | 95.11 $\pm$ 1.34              |
| TwoRoom | 0.04                     | 95.89 $\pm$ 0.42 | 96.44 $\pm$ 0.96              | 95.78 $\pm$ 0.31              | 95.89 $\pm$ 0.57              |
| TwoRoom | 0.05                     | 96.11 $\pm$ 1.50 | 96.00 $\pm$ 1.91              | 96.00 $\pm$ 1.52              | 95.89 $\pm$ 1.55              |
| TwoRoom | 0.06                     | 96.00 $\pm$ 1.70 | 95.56 $\pm$ 1.81              | 95.56 $\pm$ 1.40              | 95.78 $\pm$ 1.55              |
| TwoRoom | 0.07                     | 96.44 $\pm$ 0.63 | 96.33 $\pm$ 0.54              | 96.11 $\pm$ 0.68              | 96.44 $\pm$ 0.31              |
| TwoRoom | 0.08                     | 97.22 $\pm$ 0.83 | 97.22 $\pm$ 0.68              | 97.33 $\pm$ 0.72              | 97.11 $\pm$ 0.57              |
| PushT   | 0.00                     | 81.78 $\pm$ 4.89 | 53.56 $\pm$ 12.91             | 19.22 $\pm$ 9.12              | 7.22 $\pm$ 5.81               |
| PushT   | 0.01                     | 85.89 $\pm$ 1.50 | 82.22 $\pm$ 3.03              | 70.33 $\pm$ 6.33              | 37.89 $\pm$ 12.37             |
| PushT   | 0.02                     | 87.33 $\pm$ 0.72 | 85.11 $\pm$ 1.13              | 82.89 $\pm$ 2.69              | 62.67 $\pm$ 11.98             |
| PushT   | 0.03                     | 89.67 $\pm$ 0.00 | 89.67 $\pm$ 0.27              | 88.78 $\pm$ 2.08              | 82.44 $\pm$ 1.66              |
| PushT   | 0.04                     | 89.11 $\pm$ 0.83 | 88.22 $\pm$ 1.13              | 87.33 $\pm$ 1.19              | 86.56 $\pm$ 0.16              |
| PushT   | 0.05                     | 84.00 $\pm$ 3.03 | 84.22 $\pm$ 2.53              | 82.56 $\pm$ 3.13              | 81.11 $\pm$ 3.03              |
| PushT   | 0.06                     | 88.22 $\pm$ 1.34 | 88.89 $\pm$ 1.03              | 87.33 $\pm$ 0.47              | 86.78 $\pm$ 0.63              |
| PushT   | 0.07                     | 86.44 $\pm$ 0.87 | 86.00 $\pm$ 1.19              | 84.22 $\pm$ 0.42              | 84.00 $\pm$ 0.27              |
| PushT   | 0.08                     | 86.89 $\pm$ 1.59 | 86.56 $\pm$ 2.20              | 84.67 $\pm$ 2.88              | 85.78 $\pm$ 3.45              |
| Reacher | 0.00                     | 59.22 $\pm$ 1.03 | 42.56 $\pm$ 2.99              | 33.56 $\pm$ 1.77              | 18.22 $\pm$ 0.42              |
| Reacher | 0.01                     | 62.67 $\pm$ 1.19 | 60.67 $\pm$ 1.09              | 56.00 $\pm$ 0.72              | 44.56 $\pm$ 2.57              |
| Reacher | 0.02                     | 77.00 $\pm$ 6.18 | 76.44 $\pm$ 8.17              | 77.22 $\pm$ 6.68              | 70.33 $\pm$ 9.46              |
| Reacher | 0.03                     | 78.22 $\pm$ 1.66 | 79.33 $\pm$ 0.72              | 79.11 $\pm$ 1.10              | 76.78 $\pm$ 4.17              |
| Reacher | 0.04                     | 81.78 $\pm$ 1.59 | 82.00 $\pm$ 1.52              | 81.11 $\pm$ 2.62              | 80.56 $\pm$ 1.03              |
| Reacher | 0.05                     | 76.44 $\pm$ 4.57 | 77.33 $\pm$ 5.76              | 77.56 $\pm$ 4.01              | 77.78 $\pm$ 5.67              |
| Reacher | 0.06                     | 82.22 $\pm$ 2.79 | 79.33 $\pm$ 2.42              | 81.67 $\pm$ 1.63              | 80.67 $\pm$ 1.19              |
| Reacher | 0.07                     | 82.11 $\pm$ 2.20 | 82.44 $\pm$ 1.29              | 81.44 $\pm$ 1.85              | 83.33 $\pm$ 1.09              |
| Reacher | 0.08                     | 81.33 $\pm$ 2.33 | 82.56 $\pm$ 2.08              | 82.00 $\pm$ 1.78              | 81.56 $\pm$ 0.87              |
| Cube    | 0.00                     | 65.22 $\pm$ 1.10 | 63.00 $\pm$ 1.19              | 46.67 $\pm$ 1.96              | 43.11 $\pm$ 3.27              |
| Cube    | 0.01                     | 66.78 $\pm$ 1.81 | 67.00 $\pm$ 2.13              | 67.56 $\pm$ 2.27              | 48.78 $\pm$ 0.31              |
| Cube    | 0.02                     | 63.67 $\pm$ 2.62 | 61.44 $\pm$ 3.45              | 63.33 $\pm$ 1.96              | 56.67 $\pm$ 3.07              |
| Cube    | 0.03                     | 64.56 $\pm$ 1.66 | 63.44 $\pm$ 3.03              | 65.33 $\pm$ 0.94              | 66.00 $\pm$ 1.70              |
| Cube    | 0.04                     | 68.11 $\pm$ 1.03 | 65.11 $\pm$ 1.50              | 65.44 $\pm$ 0.57              | 64.11 $\pm$ 0.83              |
| Cube    | 0.05                     | 62.67 $\pm$ 3.40 | 63.33 $\pm$ 2.42              | 60.67 $\pm$ 3.09              | 63.56 $\pm$ 2.53              |
| Cube    | 0.06                     | 66.00 $\pm$ 1.19 | 65.89 $\pm$ 1.03              | 64.67 $\pm$ 1.09              | 64.89 $\pm$ 1.85              |
| Cube    | 0.07                     | 64.67 $\pm$ 2.16 | 64.67 $\pm$ 1.89              | 65.44 $\pm$ 2.57              | 65.22 $\pm$ 1.55              |
| Cube    | 0.08                     | 61.67 $\pm$ 3.57 | 61.78 $\pm$ 4.16              | 61.89 $\pm$ 2.45              | 62.56 $\pm$ 1.55              |